

Historical Land Use Context

Historically and currently, the 6 Bulwer Road locality has transitioned from early colonial pastoral and farming country into a large rural-residential landholding, with later planning activity in the North-West Moss Vale area supporting low-density residential/environmental living outcomes.

Context finding. The broader Throsby/Bong Bong/Moss Vale landscape was historically pastoral and agricultural. The available title, parish, Austermere and aerial evidence supports the position that the subject land sits within a historically cleared and farmed rural landscape rather than an untouched native-land context.

1. Colonial Pastoral Use (1819 - late 1800s)

Throsby Park grant

Heritage NSW records Throsby Park as the surviving core of a 1,000-acre grant made to Dr Charles Throsby by Governor Macquarie in 1819. This places the wider Moss Vale/Bong Bong locality in an early colonial pastoral-estate context.

Clearing and farming context

The surrounding Southern Highlands landscape was progressively cleared and used for pastoral and agricultural purposes, including grazing and farming connected with early estates and later rural holdings.

Equine / exercise use

Given the proximity to Throsby Park and the later repeated oval/circular ground feature visible in aerial imagery, equine exercise or similar rural recreation use is a reasonable historical interpretation, although no commercial racecourse record for this exact lot has been identified in the material reviewed.

2. Rural, Hobby-Farming and Later Planning Context (20th century - 2010s)

Rural character

The modern parcel remained a large cleared landholding of about 8.6 hectares, consistent with a rural-residential or hobby-farming pattern rather than dense urban use.

Small-scale grazing / vacant rural land

The contract and aerial material indicate a mostly open land package with cleared paddock character, access tracks and rural ground features suitable for grazing, horse keeping or similar low-intensity agricultural use.

Residential/environmental living transition

Planning material for nearby North-West Moss Vale land, including 50A Bulwer Road, records rezoning from RU2 Rural Landscape to E4 Environmental Living with a 2-hectare minimum lot size. This supports the broader transition of comparable Bulwer Road land from rural landscape holdings toward large-lot residential/environmental living outcomes.

Sources noted for this context section

- Heritage NSW, Throsby Park Historic Site listing: 1,000-acre 1819 Throsby grant context.
- NSW Planning Portal / Wingecarribee material: 50A Bulwer Road RU2 Rural Landscape to E4 Environmental Living planning proposal.
- Report evidence: contract title/plan, parish maps, Austermere Estate material and NSW Spatial Services historical aerial imagery.